

[Sholay](#) (1975) is widely regarded as one of the most influential and iconic masterpieces in Indian cinematic history. Directed by Ramesh Sippy and written by the legendary duo Salim–Javed, this action-adventure film popularized the "Masala" genre and broke box office records nationwide. [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

 Key Movie Specifications

Attribute	Details
Director	Ramesh Sippy
Writers	Salim Khan & Javed Akhtar (Salim-Javed)
Music Composer	R. D. Burman
Running Time	3 hours 24 minutes
Primary Genre	Curry Western / Action-Adventure

 Iconic Cast & Characters

The film is famous for creating characters that became permanently etched into Indian pop culture: [6, 7]

- **Veeru (Dharmendra):** The charismatic, hot-headed, and romantic thief.
- **Jai (Amitabh Bachchan):** The intense, cynical, and fiercely loyal partner-in-crime.
- **Gabbar Singh (Amjad Khan):** The sadistic, laughing dacoit chief; widely rated as Indian cinema's greatest villain.
- **Thakur Baldev Singh (Sanjeev Kumar):** The retired, armless policeman driven entirely by a thirst for justice and revenge.
- **Basanti (Hema Malini):** The talkative, energetic tanga (horse-carriage) driver.
- **Radha (Jaya Bachchan):** The quiet, stoic widowed daughter-in-law of the Thakur. [8, 9, 10, 11, 12]

Core Narrative Plot

The story is set in the isolated, rocky village of **Ramgarh**. [13, 14]

1. **The Conflict:** The ruthless bandit Gabbar Singh terrorizes the village. Years prior, he slaughtered the entire family of Thakur Baldev Singh and brutally severed the Thakur's arms. [15, 16, 17, 18]
2. **The Alliance:** Bound by his physical limitations, the Thakur hires two small-time convicts with hearts of gold—Jai and Veeru—to capture Gabbar alive. [19, 20, 21, 22, 23]
3. **The Climax:** Jai and Veeru defend the villagers, find romance, and engage in a legendary, high-stakes final showdown against Gabbar's army. [24, 25]

Cultural Legacy & Trivia

- **Dialogue Immortality:** Lines like "*Kitne aadmi the?*" (How many men were there?) and "*Jo darr gaya, samjho marr gaya*" (He who fears is dead) are still quoted daily across India. [26, 27]
- **Initial Failure:** Sholay opened to surprisingly poor reviews and low box-office collections in its first week before word-of-mouth transformed it into an unprecedented mega-blockbuster. [28, 29, 30, 31]
- **The Golden Jubilee:** The movie ran continuously for over **five years** at Mumbai's Minerva Theatre. [32, 33]

Tell me how you would like to explore this classic further:

- Do you want to read a specific breakdown of its **most famous dialogue sequences**?
- Would you like an analysis of how **R.D. Burman composed its iconic soundtrack**?
- Are you looking for a **summary of the alternative ending** that was censored by the film board?

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